HOORVIA - SSH KEYS CHEAT SHEET: PRINTABLE COMMANDS GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · A4 Printable

Tech & Software · Sheet #1

Command	What It Does	Example	Note
ssh-keygen	Generates a key pair	ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -C "email"	Use Ed25519 for new keys
ssh-keygen -t rsa	Generates an RSA key	ssh-keygen -t rsa -b 4096	For legacy systems
ssh-copy-id	Copies your public key to a server	ssh-copy-id user@host	Sets up passwordless login
ssh-add	Adds a key to the agent	ssh-add ~/.ssh/id_ed25519	Loads the key for the session
ssh-agent	Starts the key agent	eval "$(ssh-agent -s)"	Keeps keys in memory
ssh	Connects to a server	ssh user@host	Uses your key automatically
ssh -i	Uses a specific key file	ssh -i ~/.ssh/work_key user@host	For multiple keys
ssh-keygen -p	Changes a key passphrase	ssh-keygen -p -f ~/.ssh/id_ed25519	No need to regenerate
ssh-keygen -y	Shows the public key	ssh-keygen -y -f ~/.ssh/id_ed25519	Recover a lost .pub file
ssh-keyscan	Fetches a host's key	ssh-keyscan host >> ~/.ssh/known_hosts	Avoids the first-connect prompt
cat id_ed25519.pub	Shows your public key	cat ~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub	Paste this into GitHub
chmod 600	Locks down key permissions	chmod 600 ~/.ssh/id_ed25519	SSH refuses loose keys

PRO TIP: Use Ed25519 for new keys: Ed25519 is faster and shorter than RSA, and it is the modern default. Only use RSA 4096 when an old server does not support Ed25519.